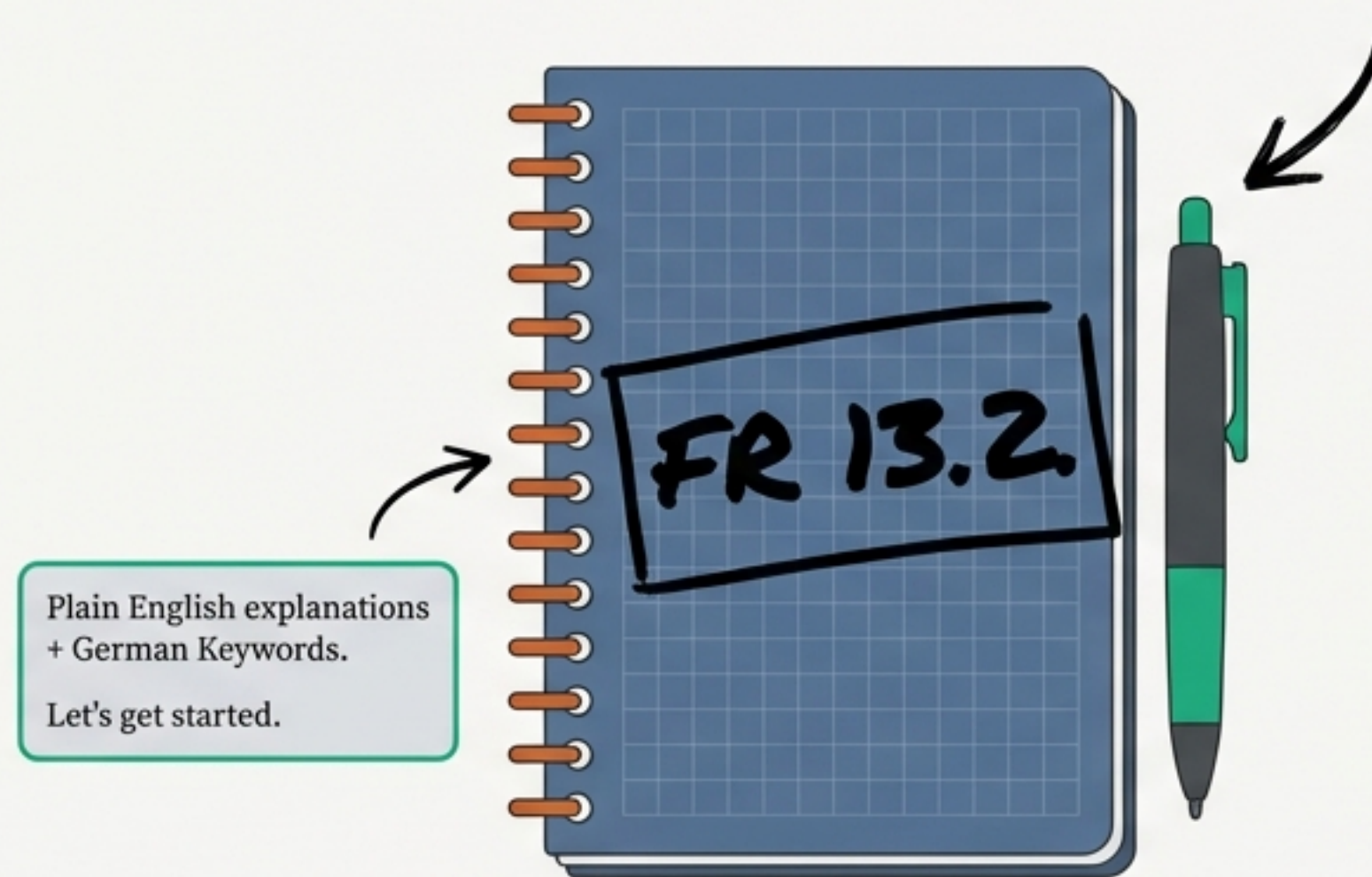


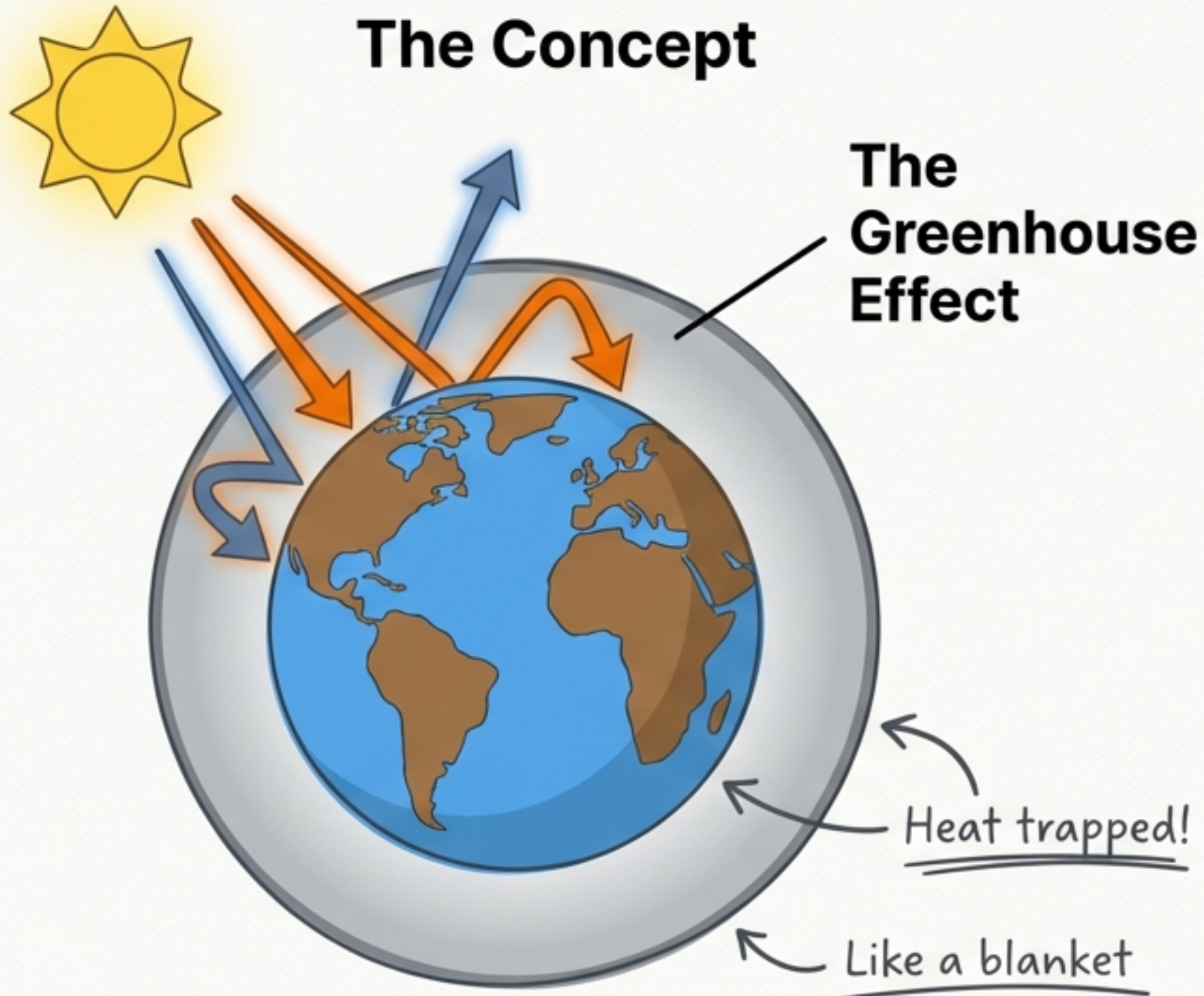
VSN Exam Survival Guide: Geography

Humans, Nature & Climate



The Earth is Getting a Fever

The Concept



The Data

0.6°C

Average global temperature
rise in the 20th Century

→ Sounds small?
For a planet, it's
a huge fever.

Vocab Box

Klimawandel	= Climate Change
Erwärmung	= Warming
Treibhauseffekt	= Greenhouse Effect

Melting Ice & Rising Seas

Water Tower

Glacier
(Water Reservoir)

Rapid Melting

Ominous rise!

Danger

Key Fact: If the Greenland Ice Sheet melts, sea levels rise by 7 meters.

→ **Projection 2100:** +2 meters

→ **20th Century:** +20cm

← Avg. rise, source text

Vocab Box

Gletscherschwund = Glacier retreat
Meeresspiegel = Sea level
Wasserspeicher = Water reservoir

Evan!

Vocab Box

Gletscherschwund = Glacier retreat
Meeresspiegel = Sea level
Wasserspeicher = Water reservoir

Crazy Weather & Broken Heating

The Sponge Effect



Europe's Central Heating

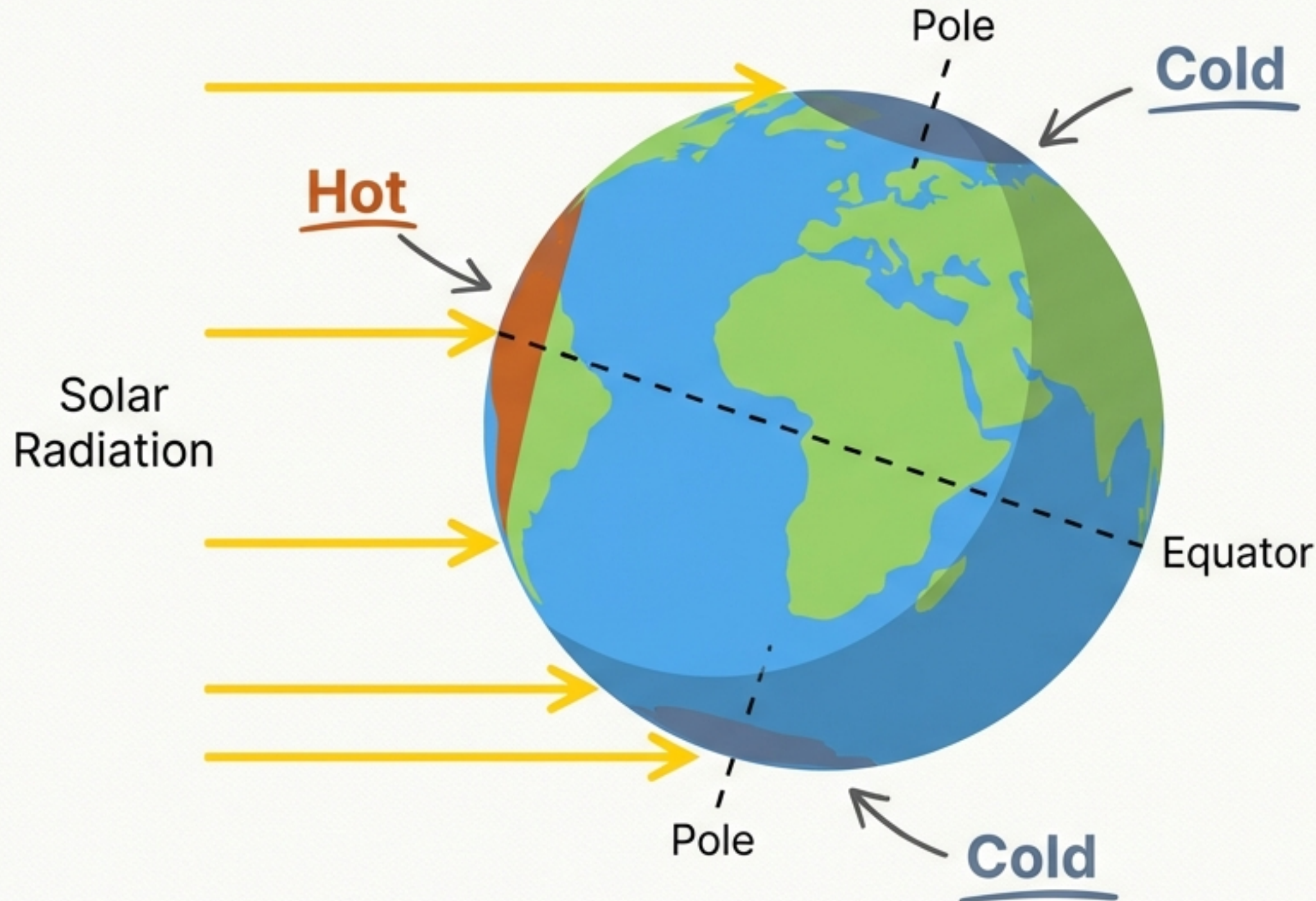


Vocab Box

Extremereignisse = Extreme events
Meeresströmungen = Ocean currents
Wasserdampf = Water vapor

Europe's Central Heating:
If fresh meltwater stops this current, Europe freezes while the world burns.

How Earth is Organized: The Landscape Zones



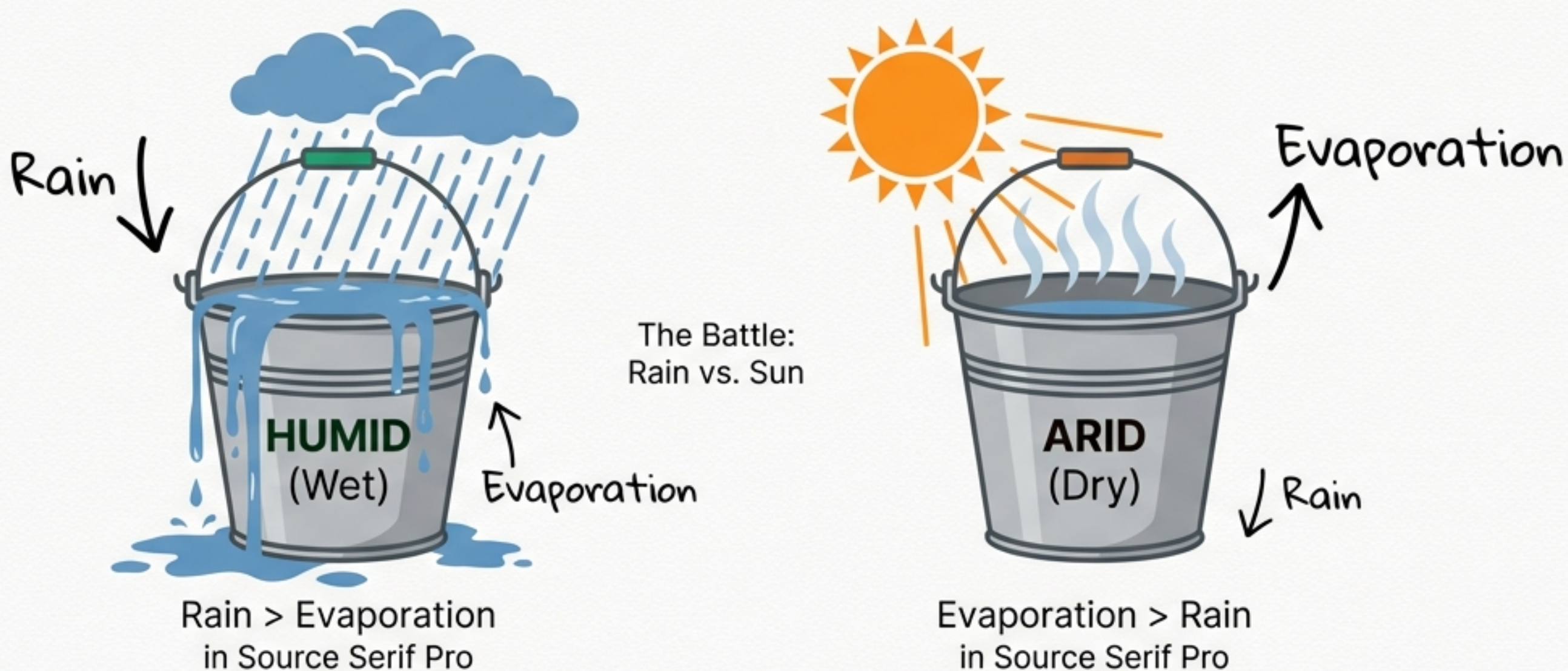
The Factors

- ☒ 1. Temperature (High/Low)
- ☒ 2. Precipitation (Rain/Snow)
- ☒ 3. Soil (Fertile/Infertile)
- ☒ 4. Relief (Flat/Steep)

Vocab Box

Landschaftsgürtel = Landscape zones
Sonneneinstrahlung = Solar radiation

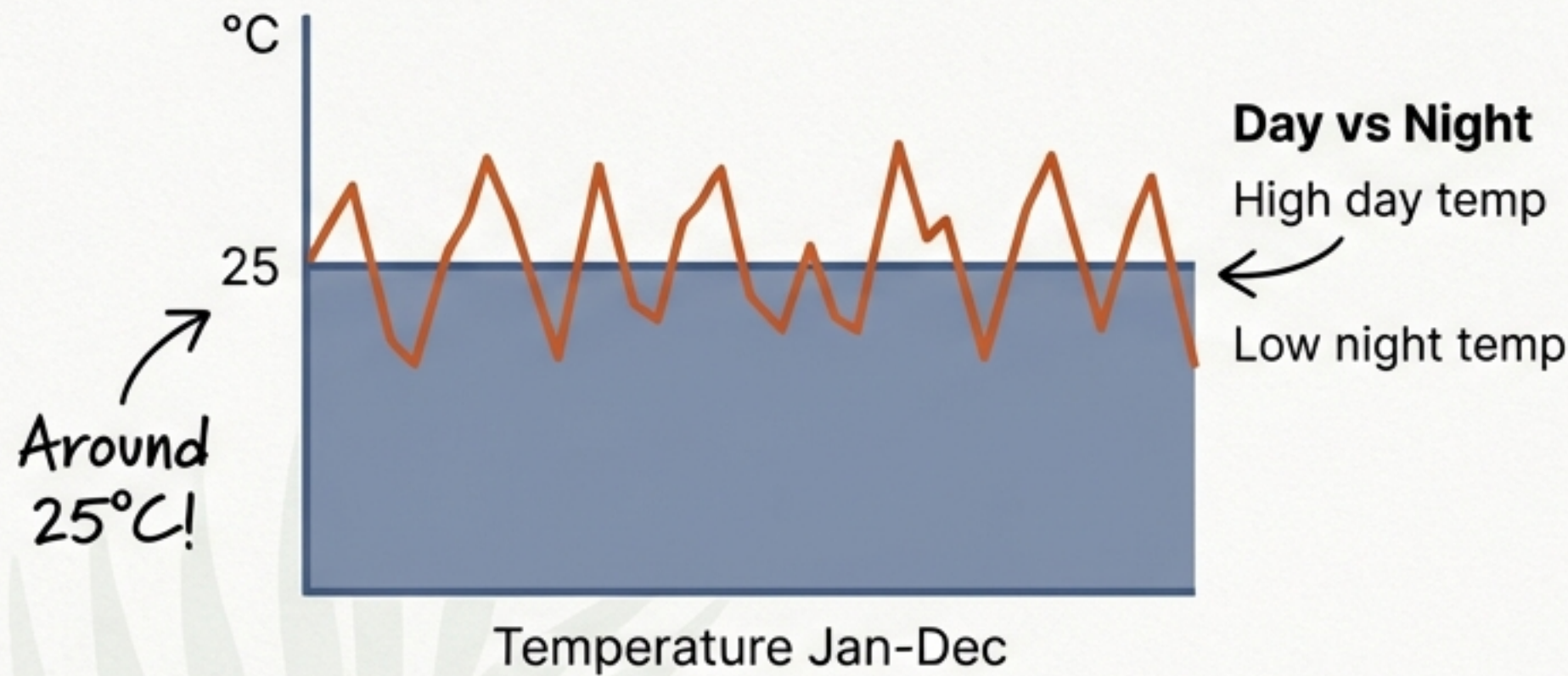
The Bucket Test: Humid or Arid?



Vocab Box
Arid = Dry
Humid = Wet
Verdunstung = Evaporation

The Green Heart: Tropical Rainforest

The Climate



No Seasons! Summer every day.

The Life



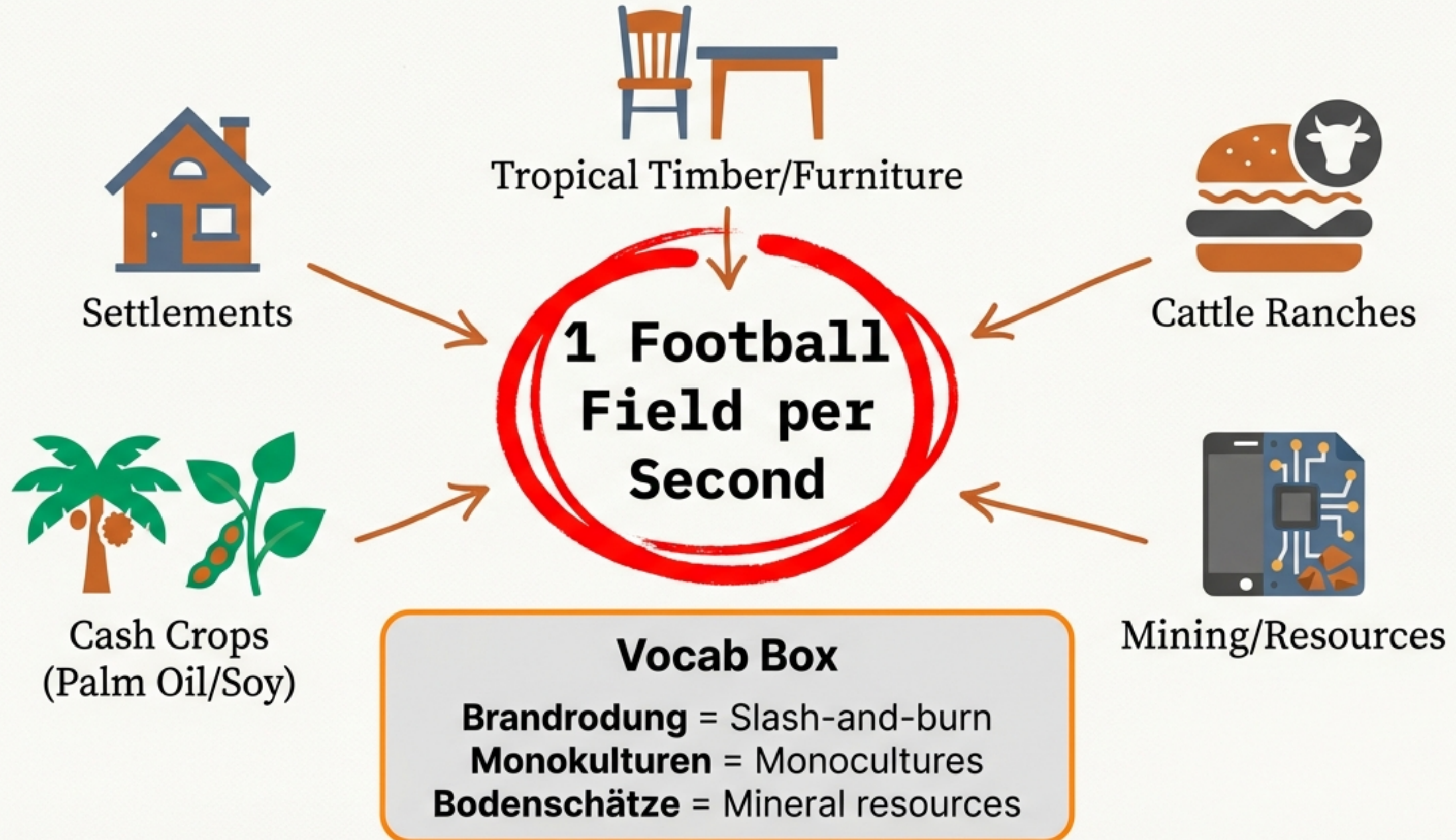
Biodiversity Hub: 3/4 of all species live here.

Vocab Box

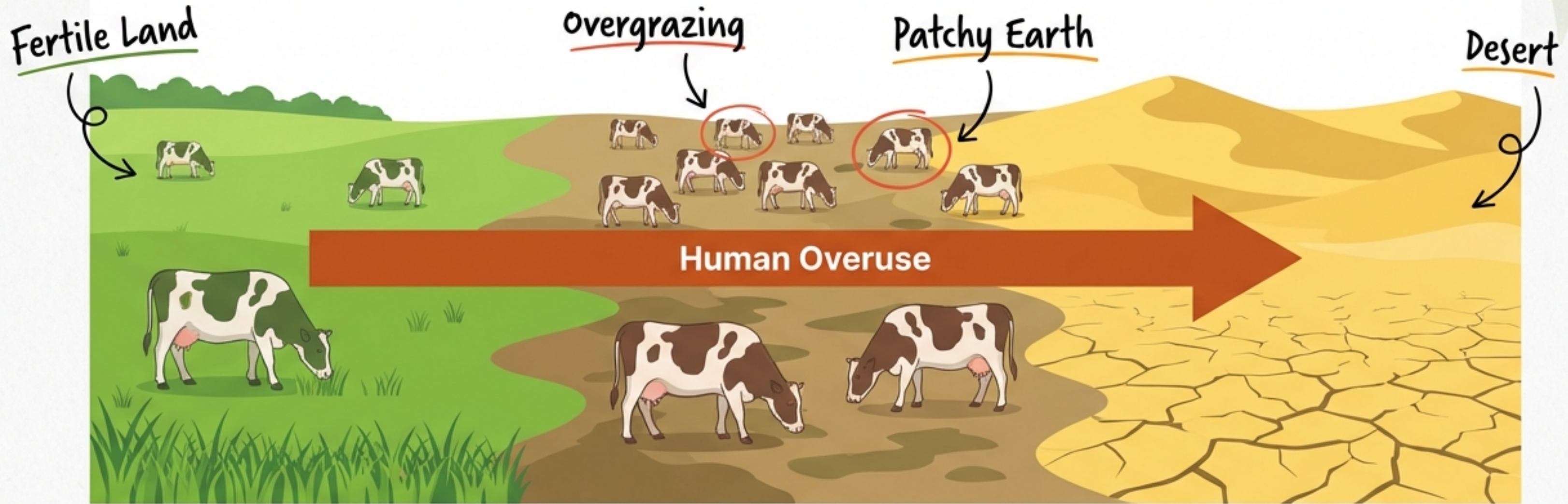
Tropischer Regenwald = Tropical rainforest

Tageszeitenklima = Diurnal climate

Why are we destroying the Rainforest?



Making Deserts: Desertification



Desertification is the spread of deserts into fertile land caused by bad farming and overgrazing.

Vocab Box

Desertifikation = Desertification
Übernutzung = Overuse

Source material
in JetBrains Mono

The 'Goldilocks' Zone: Temperate Lands

Not too hot, not too cold. 4 Distinct Seasons.

Steppes (Grasslands)



→ Too dry for trees. Interior of continents.

Deciduous Forests



→ Wet enough for trees. Lose leaves in winter.

Vocab Box

Steppe = Steppe

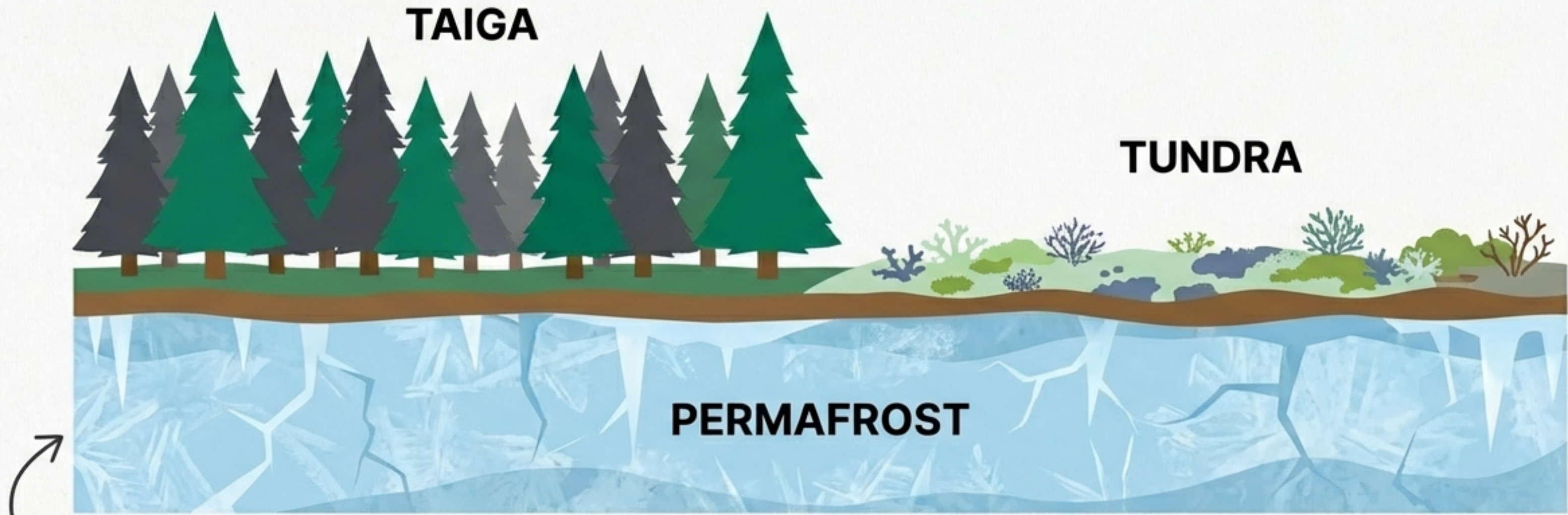
Laubwald = Deciduous forest

Gemäßigte Zone = Temperate zone

*Steppen sind feuchter als Wüsten
und trockener als Waldregionen.*

The Cold North: Taiga & Tundra

Subpolar & Polar Zones



*Frozen solid all year.
Water can't drain =
Swamps in summer.*

Vocab Box

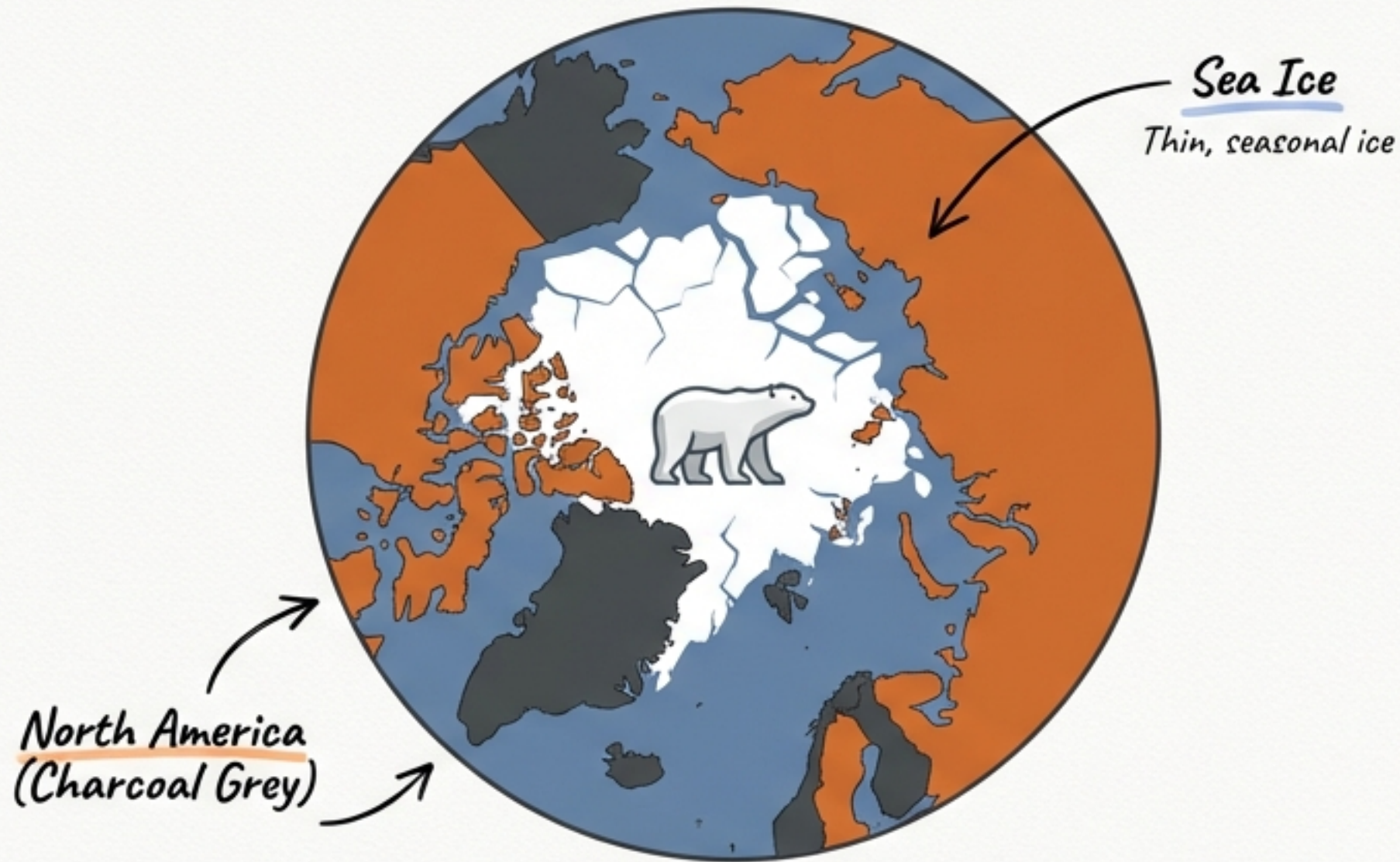
Nadelwald = Coniferous forest

Tundra = Tundra

Permafrost = Permafrost

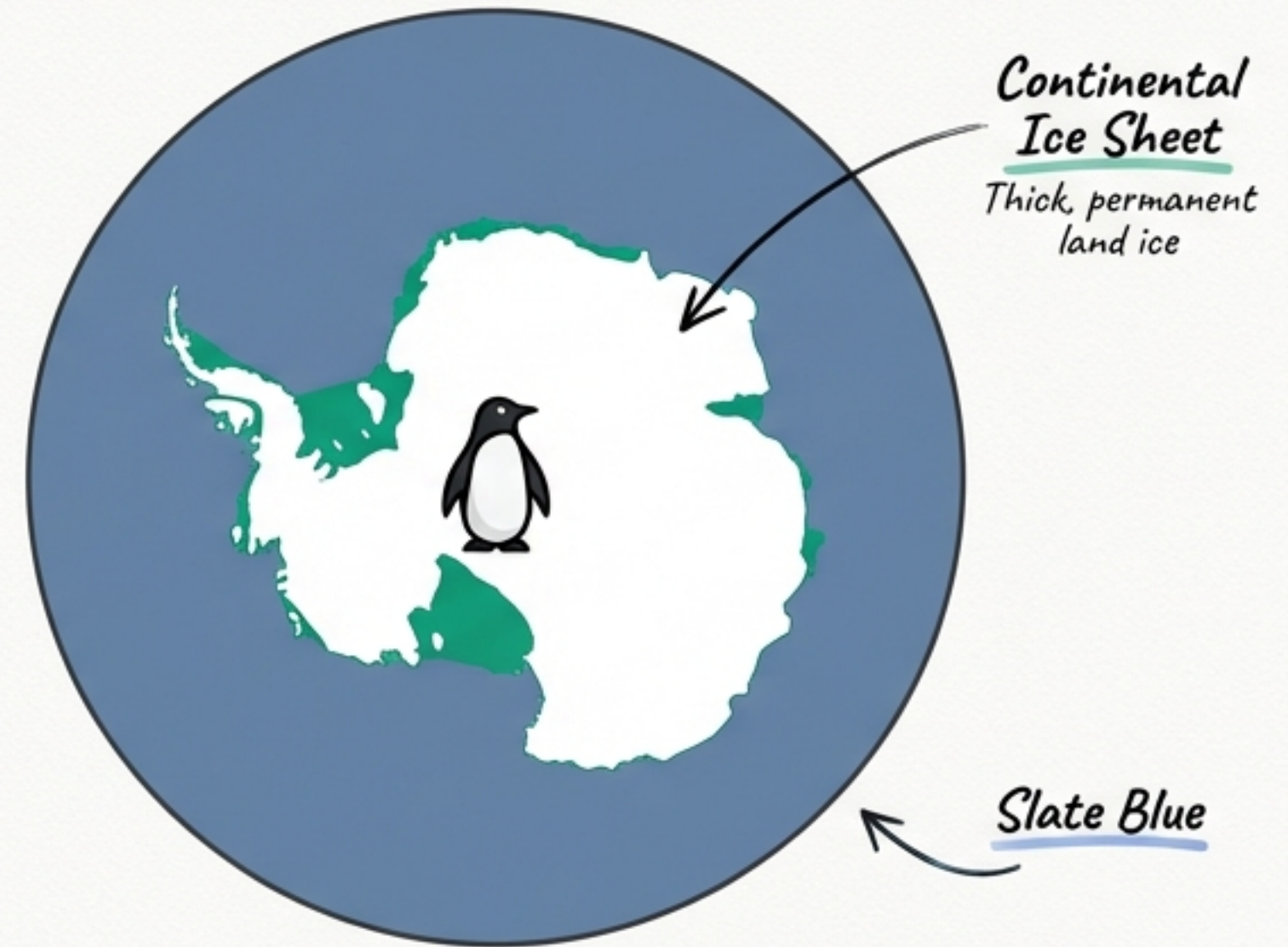
Arctic vs. Antarctica

ARCTIC (NORTH)



Frozen Ocean surrounded by Land.

ANTARCTICA (SOUTH)



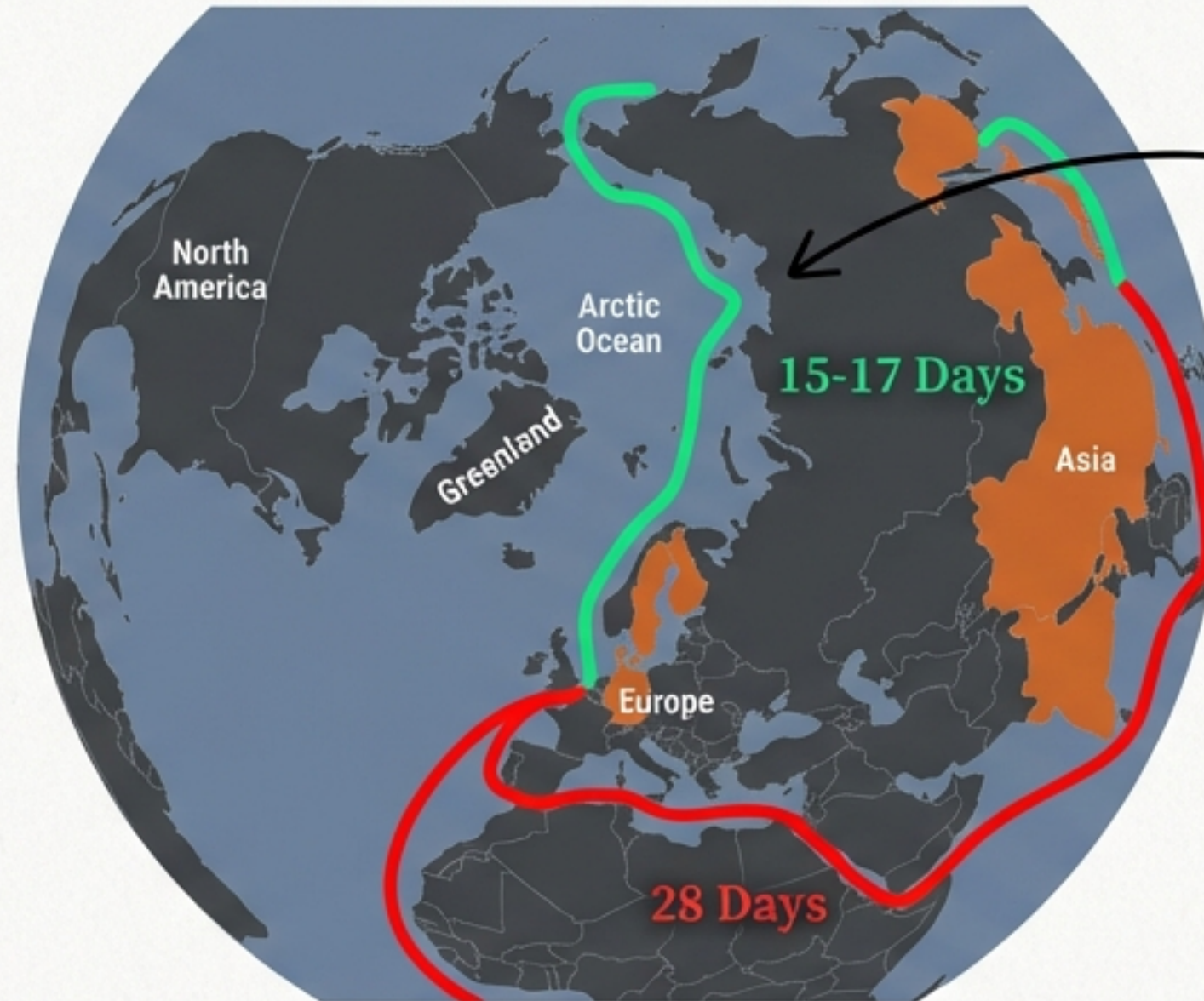
Frozen Land surrounded by Ocean.

Vocab Box

- Arktis = Arctic
- Antarktis = Antarctic
- Eisschild = Ice sheet

Reference: Geo-Facts: Polargebiete
(Süd- & Nordpolargebiet) in source text.

The Northeast Passage: A Short Cut?



Melting ice creates a new shipping highway for 3 months in summer.

Vocab Box

Nordostpassage = Northeast Passage
Handelsschiffahrt = Merchant shipping

Reference: Map shows Northeast Passage route.

The “Must Know” Vocab List

	GERMAN	ENGLISH
→	<u>Klimawandel</u>	Climate Change
→	Gletscherschwund	<u>Glacier Retreat</u>
→	Meeresspiegel	Sea Level
→	Arid / Humid	Dry / Wet
→	<u>Tageszeitenklima</u>	Diurnal Climate
→	Brandrodung	Slash-and-burn
→	Desertifikation	Desertification
→	Laubwald	<u>Deciduous Forest</u>
→	Permafrost	Frozen Ground
→	Nordostpassage	Northeast Passage

You Are Ready!



**You know the concepts.
You know the vocab. You've got this.**

Good luck on the LZK!

Friday, 13.02.2026 – The VSN Team.